

CMS.100

Assignment 1: Create a dataset (500 words)

DUE DATE: 9 am, Friday, October 16 (submit to Canvas)

Mimi Onuoha's art project "The Library of Missing Datasets" illuminates what we value and what we ignore in an increasingly data-saturated world. For example, there is little data that exists about financial transactions in the art market (especially between gallerists and artists) and on US judges and case outcomes. Think of a dataset that doesn't exist and create it.

This could be as grandiose or as mundane as you would like: it could be the temperature of a patch of grass outside your room for a week, FitBit or other health tracking data, or more substantial research on social or political phenomena. (For example, the Data Against Femicide project required scores of volunteers to track femicide throughout Latin American by reading through innumerable news articles to collect data that governments did not.) There is no requirement around time span or number of observations in this dataset; the "Dogs of Cambridge" dataset released by the city of Cambridge is not bounded by time the way that temperature is. This dataset does need to demonstrate clear inclusion and exclusion criteria, require some kind of measurement apparatus, and provide you with enough information to do some analysis about what the data shows.

To complete the assignment, you will submit:

- The dataset
- Write-up about the data collection process and what the data shows
- Data visualization of your choice